*RESEARCH IN SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGICAL EDUCATION*

01/03

FROM THE ARCHIVE · 2008

# *Girls' biology, boys' physics: evidence from free-choice science learning settings*

**Ayelet Baram-Tsabari and Anat Yarden**

Weizmann Institute of Science, Israel

DOI **doi.org/10.1080/02635140701847538**

Taylor & Francis
Taylor & Francis Group

# WHAT DID THIS PAPER CONTRIBUTE?



- The authors analysed 1,169 spontaneous questions about biology and physics sent to online and TV science services.
- Biology made up 53.8% of females' questions and 38.3% of males'; physics, 6% versus 13.2%.
- The gap widened with age, as girls seemed to develop less interest in physics than boys did.

---

**Baram-Tsabari and Yarden (2008)** · Research in Science & Technological Education · doi.org/10.1080/02635140701847538

# WHAT HAS CHANGED, AND WHY IT MATTERS



- Studying the questions learners chose to ask themselves remains a fresh alternative to rating predefined topics.
- Nearly two decades on, it invites reflection on how experiences inside and outside school shape disciplinary interests.
- Could students' spontaneous questions help make physics more inclusive without reinforcing stereotypes?

---

**Baram-Tsabari and Yarden (2008)** · Research in Science & Technological Education · doi.org/10.1080/02635140701847538